

The War Industries Board (WIB) was a United States government agency established on July 28, 1917, during World War I, to coordinate the purchase of war supplies between the War Department (Department of the Army) and the Navy Department. Because the United States Department of Defense (The Pentagon) would only come into existence in 1947, this was an ad hoc construction to promote cooperation between the Army and the Navy (with regard to procurement), it was founded by the Council of National Defense (which on its turn came into existence by the appropriation bill of August 1916). The War Industries Board was preceded by the General Munitions Board—which didn't have the authority it needed and was later strengthened and transformed into the WIB.

Under the War Industries Board, industrial production in the U.S. increased 20 percent. However, the vast majority of the war material was produced too late to do any good.

Despite its relatively brief existence, the WIB was a major step in the development of national planning and government-business cooperation in the United States, and its precedents—like the National Recovery Administration—were influential during the New Deal and World War II.

Members of the War Industries Board

The original seven members of the War Industries Board were:

Frank A. Scott (1873–1949), chairman

Bernard M. Baruch

Robert S. Brookings, head of the Cupples Co., a distribution firm

Robert S. Lovett, President of Union Pacific Railroad

Hugh Frayne, of the American Federation of Labor and former president of the Pennsylvania AFL-CIO

Army Brigadier General Palmer E. Pierce

Admiral Frank F. Fletcher

Other later members included:

Major General James B. Aleshire, Army member of the priorities committee

Chandler P. Anderson, special counsel on international affairs

George Newell Armsby, member of the priorities committee

Lewis R. Atwood, chief of the paint and pigment section

Captain Clarence Bamberger, assistant chief of forgings, guns, etc., section

Ollie Josephine Prescott Baird Bennett

Robert J. Bulkley, chief of legal section

Samuel P. Bush, chief of ordnance (small arms, ammunition)

Anthony Caminetti, member of war prison labor and national waste reclamation section

March F. Chase (1876–1935), director of explosives division

Coker Fifield Clarkson, member of the automotive products section

William L. Clayton, member of cotton distribution committee

John Lee Coulter, staff expert, division of planning and statistics

William Byron Colver, member of the price fixing committee

Charles H. Conner, chief of platinum section, wood chemical section and gold and silver section

John M. Curran, member of conservation division

Clarence Dillon, partner in Dillon, Read & Co.

Charles Edgar (1862–1922), director of lumber

Colonel George Henson Estes, Army representative, requirements division

Felix Frankfurter, Labor Department representative on priorities board

Harry Augustus Garfield, member of the price fixing committee

Edwin Francis Gay, chairman, planning and statistics division

Army General George Washington Goethals (became a member in 1918)

Joseph F. Guffey, chief of petroleum section

Commander John Milton Hancock, Navy member of the price fixing committee

Charles P. Howland, member of the priorities committee

Brigadier General Hugh S. Johnson

Colonel Charles Keller, joint national power administrator

Victor L. King, chairman of the dye section

Henry Krumb, member of the priorities committee

Alexander Legge, selected by President Woodrow Wilson as vice chairman after the reorganization in March 1918

Charles Kenneth Leith, chief of mica section and mineral import-export advisor

Isador Lubin, staff expert, division of planning and statistics

Charles H. MacDowell (1867–1954), director of chemical division

Rear Admiral Newton E. Mason, Navy member of the priorities committee

Joseph A. McDonald, staff expert, steel division

Rear Admiral Samuel McGowan, Navy representative, conservation division

Eugene Meyer, Special Advisor to the War Industries Board on Non-Ferrous Metals

Wesley Clair Mitchell, chief of price statistics

Lieutenant Colonel Robert Hiester Montgomery, Army member of the price fixing committee

Herbert R. Moody (1868–1947), chief of the technical branch of the chemistry division

R. V. Norris (1864–1928), representative of U.S. Fuel Administration on the price-fixing commission

P. B. Noyes, Fuel Administration representative on requirements division and priorities board

Edwin B. Parker, head of priorities division

Herbert E. Peabody (died 1930), head of woolen goods section, textile and rubber division

George N. Peek, commissioner of finished products

Thomas Nelson Perkins (1870–1937), member of priorities commission and chief council

Charles Piez, Emergency Fleet Corporation representative on priorities board

Thomas C. Powell, manager of inland traffic and member of the priorities committee

J. Leonard Replogle, director of steel supply

Albert C. Ritchie, general counsel

Adolph G. Rosengarten (1870–1946), chief of miscellaneous chemical section

Hugh W. Sanford (1879–1961), chief of the ferro-alloys section

Jacob F. Schoellkopf Jr. (1858–1942), member of chemical division

Arch Wilkinson Shaw, head of conservation division

Edward Stettinius Sr., partner in J.P. Morgan & Co.

Walter W. Stewart, staff member, division of planning and statistics

George Cameron Stone, head of Non-Ferrous Metal section

Henry Carter Stuart, member of the price fixing committee

Leland L. Summers, technical advisor and chair of Foreign Mission

Herbert Bayard Swope, assistant to Bernard Baruch

Frank William Taussig, member of the price fixing committee

Samuel M. Vauclain, chairman, special advisory subcommittee on plants and munitions

Edward R. Weidlein, technical advisor, chemical division

Louis S. Weiss, member of legal section

Theodore Whitmarsh

Daniel Willard (1861–1942), chairman of the War Industries Board

Harrison Williams, member of facilities division

Major Seth Williams, Marine Corps Representative to the Board (Requirements Division);

Future Quartermaster of the Marine Corps in 1937-1944.

Leo Wolman, staff member, division of planning and statistics

Pope Yeatman, head, non-ferrous metals division

References

Further reading

Clarkson, Grosvenor (1923). *Industrial America in the World War*. ISBN 978-0-891-98097-1.

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Cuff, Robert D. (1973). *The War Industries Board: Business-Government Relations During World War I*. Johns Hopkins University Press. ISBN 978-0-801-81360-3.

Gilbert, James B. (1972). *Designing the Industrial State*. ISBN 978-0-812-90219-8.

External links

Records of the WIB at the National Archives

Media related to War Industries Board at Wikimedia Commons